

**LISTENING**
#29**Teacher's Guide**

SCRIPT: NEGOTIATING SHIPMENT DATES

Beata: Yes, I know that Daniel cleared the existing schedule, but it doesn't change anything. We still need the shipment by the 10th. As I said earlier, I have no room for (to) maneuver on this.

Clarice: It's a pity we don't have another container leaving this week. We could have sent them straight away. As I said, they're ready to go.

Beata: So, it seems to me we have two problems here. I need the components to arrive by the tenth. You need to be able to cover additional costs. How about this: I could speak to one of our other suppliers. We have another container leaving China this week. Maybe they'll have some space.

Clarice: That could work. We're talking two cubic meters maximum.

Beata: Let me make some calls.

Clarice: I'll see if we can get the components down to the docks in time. (I'm) Pretty sure we can. Do you know where the container is right now?

Beata: Probably still in the factory.

Clarice: Where's that?

Beata: I couldn't point it out on a map, but I know it's in Guangzhou. That's near Shenzhen, right? Looks like this could be a win for both of us.

Clarice: A big win. And all before lunchtime, too.

Audio Comprehension Questions:

1. a) He cleared it
2. By the 10th
3. There is no container leaving this week
4. Two cubic meters
5. b) The parts must arrive by the 10th, and extra costs must be covered
6. b) in the factory
7. Ask another supplier's container for some space

Reading Comprehension Questions

1. He discovers that an important shipment from Taiwan hasn't left the warehouse yet.
2. It leaves too late
3. Shared space in another supplier's container

Idioms/Useful Expressions

“No room to maneuver” = no flexibility to change or adjust something

Beata says: “I have no room to maneuver on this.”

“Let out a long breath” = exhaled deeply to release tension

The text says: “Tomas leaned back... and let out a long breath.”